

Figure 1: Using layers to create an image

the freedom to edit, share, delete and modify as you like. Pretty much like the FOSS idea, isn't it?

We did learn a bit about the layer box in the previous tutorial. For those of you who missed it, the layer box is the third window to the left, right after the GIMP loads up. Previously, we just had an overview of the layer box. So in this tutorial we will get started with the details and learn the various aspects of the layer box.

Starting from the top, the layer box has a layer switcher. As stated earlier, this helps in switching layers when working with multiple images. Though it is set on 'auto', it means that once you click the window of another image, the layer box will automatically list all the layers involved in the selected image window, but in case it doesn't work, you can use this switcher to make it work for you.

This switcher also comes in very handy while copying a layer of an image onto another, making the transition smoother and brisk. Figure 2 shows the function of the layer switcher.

What follows is the most important section, in which we will apply all the effects and styles to the layer. Figure 3 illustrates almost all the functions of the layer section that we need to work on.

- **Layer modes:** Since we have understood a bit about layers, let's move on to the different ways you can set a layer in. Layer mode does away with all the frustrating methods, with just a simple drop down. Just select a layer and set it to apply different effects. In the 'Bravo' example, the layers are set in Normal mode. You can change the mode from Normal to Overlay, and to Colour or any other pre-set, to provide the desired effect to your image. We will learn to work with them in upcoming tutorials.
- **Opacity slider:** This slide lets you set the opacity of the layer. You can either make the layer effects transparent, opaque or set it inbetween. Another handy tool that helps you achieve great effects and is just a drag away.

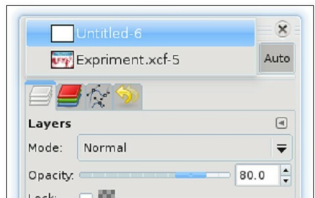


Figure 2: The layer switcher in action

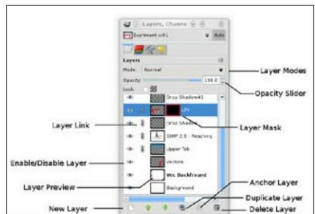


Figure 3: The layer toolbox with all the options listed

- **Layer list:** The middle section lists all the layers added in the image. Here, you can drag, delete, disable/enable and even lock a layer depending on the effect you are looking for.
- **Layer tools:** Listed below are the tools used to arrange layers:
- **New layer:** This lets you create a new layer. You can make it either opaque or transparent. It also allows you to fill a layer with colour. New layer has another important function, which we shall discuss later in this tutorial.